# THE RIG VEDIC AGE (EARLY VEDIC)

**RIG VEDA AS SOURCE → SAPTA-SINDHU TEXTUAL GEOGRAPHY → KIN POLITY: AUTHORITY WITHOUT → CATTLE-AGRICULTURE ECONOMY LOOP → SOCIETY: KINSHIP, DIFFERENCE AND → DEITIES, RITA, YAJNA AND**

Read the thick cyan rail from Stage 00 to the final core synthesis. Each card uses a concept-appropriate structure; the grey E card is optional enrichment only and never repairs missing core content.

◆ PRIMARY CORE FLOW ◆ SUBORDINATE EXTRA ◆ APPROVAL / REVIEW

CORE BEFORE EXTRA • prior artefacts unchanged • exact same master drives poster and tiles

Approval: FALSE • Pending user review • source generation g15 and all prior artifacts unchanged

00

## STAGE 00 RIG VEDA AS SOURCE AND CHRONOLOGICAL SPINE

RIG VEDA AS SOURCE AND CHRONOLOGICAL SPINE · FAMILY BOOKS (2-7) · OTHER LAYERS (1, 8, 9, 10) · REDACTION/ORAL PRESERVATION EARLIER CORE TRENDS VARIED/LATER MATERIAL DISCIPLINED TRANSMISSION · WORKING EARLY VEDIC HORIZON · BROADLY C. 1500-1000 BCE, NOT A DATE FOR EVERY · TEXT GIVES A POETIC-RITUAL WORLD; FREQUENCY AND SILENCE ARE

FAMILY BOOKS (2-7) → OTHER LAYERS (1, 8, 9, 10) → REDACTION/ORAL PRESERVATION earlier core → Working early Vedic horizon: broadly c. 1500-1000 BCE, not a date for every hymn. → Text gives a poetic-ritual world; frequency and silence are not census data.

### CHRONOLOGY / PHASE

- FAMILY BOOKS (2-7) → OTHER LAYERS (1, 8, 9, 10) → REDACTION/ORAL PRESERVATION earlier core trends varied/later material disciplined transmission
- Working early Vedic horizon: broadly c. 1500-1000 BCE, not a date for every hymn.

### MATERIAL / INSTITUTION

- Text gives a poetic-ritual world; frequency and silence are not census data.
- FAMILY BOOKS (2-7) → OTHER LAYERS (1, 8, 9, 10) → REDACTION/ORAL PRESERVATION earlier core trends varied/later material disciplined transmission

### IMPACT / LIMIT

- Working early Vedic horizon; broadly c. 1500-1000 BCE, not a date for every hymn.
- Text gives a poetic-ritual world; frequency and silence are not census data.

**ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Text gives a poetic-ritual world; frequency and silence are not census data.**

01

## STAGE 01 SAPTA-SINDHU TEXTUAL GEOGRAPHY

SAPTA-SINDHU TEXTUAL GEOGRAPHY · NORTH-WESTERN MILIEU · KABUL/KUBHA ---- INDUS/SINDHU ---- PUNJAB RIVERS ---- SARASVATI/DRISHADVATI ZONE · RIVERS ORGANISE PRAISE, MOVEMENT, PASTURE AND CONFLICT; GEOGRAPHY IS · GANGA IS MARGINAL IN THIS HORIZON; LATER VEDIC EXPANSION · DO NOT TURN REMEMBERED RIVERS INTO PRECISE POLITICAL BORDERS.

NORTH-WESTERN MILIEU

Kabul/Kubha ---- Indus/Sindhu ---- Punjab rivers ---- Sarasvati/Drishadvati zone mountain routes trunk river pastoral/farming eastern → Rivers organise praise, movement, pasture and conflict; geography is selective. → Ganga is marginal in this horizon; later Vedic expansion shifts the centre east.

### POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY

- NORTH-WESTERN MILIEU
- Kabul/Kubha ---- Indus/Sindhu ---- Punjab rivers ---- Sarasvati/Drishadvati zone mountain routes trunk river pastoral/farming eastern attention

### EVIDENCE / MECHANISM

- Rivers organise praise, movement, pasture and conflict; geography is selective.
- Ganga is marginal in this horizon; later Vedic expansion shifts the centre east.

### DEBATE / LEGACY

- Do not turn remembered rivers into precise political borders.
- NORTH-WESTERN MILIEU

**ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Do not turn remembered rivers into precise political borders.**

02

## STAGE 02 KIN POLITY: AUTHORITY WITHOUT TERRITORIAL STATE

KIN POLITY · AUTHORITY WITHOUT TERRITORIAL STATE · WAR LEADERSHIP, PROTECTION, DISTRIBUTION AND RITUAL STATUS; NOT ABSOLUTE · SMALLER/SELECT ASSEMBLY CONTEXT · BROADER ASSEMBLY PUROHITA · MARTIAL ROLE · GROUP LEADER · OFFERING/TRIBUTE, NOT A REGULAR LAND-REVENUE BUREAUCRACY

KULA → GRAMA → VIS → JANA → RAJAN: war leadership, protection, distribution and ritual status; not absolute monarch sabha: smaller/select assembly context → samiti: broader assembly purohita: adviser → senani: martial role → gramani: group leader

### POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY

- KULA → GRAMA → VIS → JANA
- RAJAN: war leadership, protection, distribution and ritual status; not absolute monarch sabha: smaller/select assembly context
- samiti: broader assembly purohita: adviser

### EVIDENCE / MECHANISM

- senani: martial role
- gramani: group leader
- bali: offering/tribute, not a regular land-revenue bureaucracy

### DEBATE / LEGACY

- Power rested on kin support, cattle, gifts, assemblies and successful leadership.

**ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Power rested on kin support, cattle, gifts, assemblies and successful leadership.**

03

## STAGE 03 CATTLE-AGRICULTURE ECONOMY LOOP

CATTLE-AGRICULTURE ECONOMY LOOP · PASTURE + WATER · CATTLE WEALTH · DAIRY, TRACTION, GIFTS, STATUS AND CONFLICT MIXED FARMING · BARLEY/YAVA + CULTIVATION + CRAFTS + EXCHANGE + HOUSEHOLD · PASTORAL PREDOMINANCE DOES NOT MEAN ABSENCE OF AGRICULTURE OR · PASTURE + WATER → CATTLE WEALTH → dairy, traction, gifts, status and conflict mixed farming → + cultivation + crafts + exchange + household production mobility and raiding settlement and seasonal → Pastoral predominance does not mean absence of agriculture or exchange.

### POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY

- PASTURE + WATER → CATTLE WEALTH → dairy, traction, gifts, status and conflict mixed farming: barley/yava
- + cultivation + crafts + exchange + household production mobility and raiding settlement and seasonal cropping

### EVIDENCE / MECHANISM

- Pastoral predominance does not mean absence of agriculture or exchange.
- PASTURE + WATER → CATTLE WEALTH → dairy, traction, gifts, status and conflict mixed farming: barley/yava

### DEBATE / LEGACY

- + cultivation + crafts + exchange + household production mobility and raiding settlement and seasonal cropping
- Pastoral predominance does not mean absence of agriculture or exchange.

**ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Pastoral predominance does not mean absence of agriculture or exchange.**

04

## STAGE 04 SOCIETY: KINSHIP, DIFFERENCE AND PROJECTION LIMITS

KINSHIP, DIFFERENCE AND PROJECTION LIMITS · HOUSEHOLD/KIN ORDER PATRILINEAL MARRIAGE PATRON-CLIENT DASA/DASYU STATUS GROUPS TENDENCY · PURUSHA SUKTA IS LATE IN THE CORPUS; LATER JATI · HOUSEHOLD/KIN ORDER PATRILINEAL MARRIAGE

HOUSEHOLD/KIN ORDER patrilineal marriage patron-client dasa/dasyu status groups tendency alliances gift ties varied terms priests/warriors/commoners

Purusha Sukta is late in the corpus; later jati cannot be back-projected.

### POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY

- HOUSEHOLD/KIN ORDER patrilineal marriage patron-client dasa/dasyu status groups tendency alliances gift ties varied terms priests/warriors/commoners
- Purusha Sukta is late in the corpus; later jati cannot be back-projected.

### EVIDENCE / MECHANISM

- HOUSEHOLD/KIN ORDER patrilineal marriage patron-client dasa/dasyu status groups tendency alliances gift ties varied terms priests/warriors/commoners
- Purusha Sukta is late in the corpus; later jati cannot be back-projected.

### DEBATE / LEGACY

- HOUSEHOLD/KIN ORDER patrilineal marriage patron-client dasa/dasyu status groups tendency alliances gift ties varied terms priests/warriors/commoners
- Purusha Sukta is late in the corpus; later jati cannot be back-projected.

**ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Purusha Sukta is late in the corpus; later jati cannot be back-projected.**

05

## STAGE 05 DEITIES, RITA, YAJNA AND SOMA

DEITIES, RITA, YAJNA AND SOMA · ORDERED TRUTH AND COSMIC-SOCIAL REGULARITY · PRAISE + OFFERING + PRIESTLY SPEECH · PROTECTION, CATTLE AND VICTORY · RELIGION LINKS ECOLOGY, WARFARE, GIFT ECONOMY AND ORDER; TEMPLES

RITA: ordered truth and cosmic-social regularity → DEITIES: Indra-war/rain → YAJNA: praise + offering + priestly speech → protection, cattle and victory → Religion links ecology, warfare, gift economy and order; temples are not central.

### POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY

- RITA: ordered truth and cosmic-social regularity
- DEITIES: Indra-war/rain

### EVIDENCE / MECHANISM

- YAJNA: praise + offering + priestly speech → protection, cattle and victory
- Religion links ecology, warfare, gift economy and order; temples are not central.

### DEBATE / LEGACY

- RITA: ordered truth and cosmic-social regularity
- DEITIES: Indra-war/rain

**ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Religion links ecology, warfare, gift economy and order; temples are not central.**

06

## STAGE 06 CONFLICT, TECHNOLOGY AND CULTURAL INTERACTION

CONFLICT, TECHNOLOGY AND CULTURAL INTERACTION · HORSE/CHARIOT + BOWS/WEAPONS + MOBILE WAR BANDS CATTLE RAIDS · TEXTUAL CHARIOT TERMS MATTER; ARCHAEOLOGICAL CORRELATION REMAINS INDEPENDENT. · CONTESTS + DASHARAJNA COALITION CONFLICT LEADERSHIP AND PRESTIGE CONTACT

horse/chariot + bows/weapons + mobile war bands cattle raids + route/pasture → contests + Dasharajna coalition conflict leadership and prestige contact and incorporation → Textual chariot terms matter; archaeological correlation remains independent.

### POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY

- horse/chariot + bows/weapons + mobile war bands cattle raids + route/pasture
- contests + Dasharajna coalition conflict leadership and prestige contact and incorporation

### EVIDENCE / MECHANISM

- Textual chariot terms matter; archaeological correlation remains independent.
- horse/chariot + bows/weapons + mobile war bands cattle raids + route/pasture

### DEBATE / LEGACY

- contests + Dasharajna coalition conflict leadership and prestige contact and incorporation
- Textual chariot terms matter; archaeological correlation remains independent.

**ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Textual chariot terms matter; archaeological correlation remains independent.**

07

## STAGE 07 EARLY TO LATER VEDIC TRANSFORMATION

EARLY TO LATER VEDIC TRANSFORMATION · EARLY VEDIC LATER VEDIC NORTH-WEST/SAPTA-SINDHU UPPER GANGA-YAMUNA AND EASTWARD · CUMULATIVE TRANSFORMATION WITH REGIONAL VARIATION, NOT ABRUPT RUPTURE. · JANAPADA, STRONGER MONARCHY AND RATNINS CATTLE-CENTRED MIXED ECONOMY PLOUGH

| POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY | EVIDENCE / MECHANISM | DEBATE / LEGACY |
|---|---|---|
| EARLY VEDIC LATER VEDIC north-west/Sapta-Sindhu upper Ganga-Yamuna and eastward movement jana and kin leadership | differentiation firmer varna/patriarchy and gotra deity praise and yajna royal ritual and Upanishadic questioning | EARLY VEDIC LATER VEDIC north-west/Sapta-Sindhu upper Ganga-Yamuna and eastward movement jana and kin leadership |
| janapada, stronger monarchy and ratnins cattle-centred mixed economy plough agriculture, surplus and crafts fluid | VERDICT: cumulative transformation with regional variation, not abrupt rupture. | janapada, stronger monarchy and ratnins cattle-centred mixed economy plough agriculture, surplus and crafts fluid |

### POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY

- EARLY VEDIC LATER VEDIC north-west/Sapta-Sindhu upper Ganga-Yamuna and eastward movement jana and kin leadership
- janapada, stronger monarchy and ratnins cattle-centred mixed economy plough agriculture, surplus and crafts fluid

### EVIDENCE / MECHANISM

- differentiation firmer varna/patriarchy and gotra deity praise and yajna royal ritual and Upanishadic questioning
- VERDICT: cumulative transformation with regional variation, not abrupt rupture.

### DEBATE / LEGACY

- EARLY VEDIC LATER VEDIC north-west/Sapta-Sindhu upper Ganga-Yamuna and eastward movement jana and kin leadership
- janapada, stronger monarchy and ratnins cattle-centred mixed economy plough agriculture, surplus and crafts fluid

**MECHANISM / VERDICT —** VERDICT: cumulative transformation with regional variation, not abrupt rupture.

**ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: cumulative transformation with regional variation, not abrupt rupture.**

08

## STAGE 08 RIG VEDIC ANSWER ARCHITECTURE

RIG VEDIC ANSWER ARCHITECTURE · 10 MARKS · SOURCE CAUTION · HYMN TERM · 15 MARKS · ARCHAEOLOGY CAUTION · 20 MARKS · KIN SYSTEM

### POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY

- 10 MARKS: source caution → institution/economy → hymn term → qualification
- 15 MARKS: geography → polity → economy → society → religion → archaeology caution

### EVIDENCE / MECHANISM

- 20 MARKS: corpus/layers → Sapta-Sindhu → kin system → cattle-agriculture loop
- differentiation → ritual worldview → conflict/contact → transition

### DEBATE / LEGACY

- AVOID: nomad-only, caste-complete, state/empire or homogeneous-date claims.
- CLOSE: a layered pastoral-agricultural kin society undergoing differentiation.

**ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: source caution → institution/economy → hymn term → qualification.**

09

## STAGE 09 EVIDENCE LADDER AND CONFIDENCE CONTROL

EVIDENCE LADDER AND CONFIDENCE CONTROL · EVIDENCE LADDER · 1. TIE EACH CLAIM TO RIGVEDIC LAYER, GENRE, TERM · 2. TREAT ARCHAEOLOGY AS A CORRELATION FOR SETTLEMENT AND · 3. USE LATER VEDIC EVIDENCE ONLY FOR EXPLICIT COMPARISON · THE CORPUS GIVES STRONG PATTERNS BUT NOT A CENSUS · TRANSLATE SANSKRIT TERMS BY CONTEXT AND STATE UNCERTAINTY.

| SOURCE / MATERIAL | METHOD / DEBATE | HISTORICAL RESULT |
|---|---|---|
| EVIDENCE LADDER | 2. Treat archaeology as a correlation for settlement and technology, not language. | VERDICT: The corpus gives strong patterns but not a census or exact institutional code. |
| 1. Tie each claim to Rigvedic layer, genre, term cluster and oral transmission. | 3. Use Later Vedic evidence only for explicit comparison, never backward projection. | EVIDENCE LADDER |

### SOURCE / MATERIAL

- EVIDENCE LADDER
- 1. Tie each claim to Rigvedic layer, genre, term cluster and oral transmission.

### METHOD / DEBATE

- 2. Treat archaeology as a correlation for settlement and technology, not language.
- 3. Use Later Vedic evidence only for explicit comparison, never backward projection.

### HISTORICAL RESULT

- VERDICT: The corpus gives strong patterns but not a census or exact institutional code.
- EVIDENCE LADDER

**MECHANISM / VERDICT —** VERDICT: The corpus gives strong patterns but not a census or exact institutional code.

**ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: The corpus gives strong patterns but not a census or exact institutional code.**

10

## STAGE 10 EXAMINER TRAPS AND CONTESTED BOUNDARIES

EXAMINER TRAPS AND CONTESTED BOUNDARIES · CLOSE DISTINCTIONS · 1. PASTORAL PREDOMINANCE IS NOT PURE PASTORALISM; RAJAN IS · 2. SABHA, SAMITI AND VIDATHA ARE NOT MODERN DEMOCRATIC · 3. PURUSHA SUKTA IS A LATER BOOK 10 ARTICULATION · TRANSLATE SANSKRIT TERMS BY CONTEXT AND STATE UNCERTAINTY.

| POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY | EVIDENCE / MECHANISM | DEBATE / LEGACY |
|---|---|---|
| CLOSE DISTINCTIONS | 2. Sabha, samiti and vidatha are not modern democratic parliaments. | VERDICT: Translate Sanskrit terms by context and state uncertainty. |
| 1. Pastoral predominance is not pure pastoralism; rajan is chief, not emperor. | 3. Purusha Sukta is a later Book 10 articulation; ayas is not automatically iron. | CLOSE DISTINCTIONS |

### POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY

- CLOSE DISTINCTIONS
- 1. Pastoral predominance is not pure pastoralism; rajan is chief, not emperor.

### EVIDENCE / MECHANISM

- 2. Sabha, samiti and vidatha are not modern democratic parliaments.
- 3. Purusha Sukta is a later Book 10 articulation; ayas is not automatically iron.

### DEBATE / LEGACY

- VERDICT: Translate Sanskrit terms by context and state uncertainty.
- CLOSE DISTINCTIONS

**MECHANISM / VERDICT —** VERDICT: Translate Sanskrit terms by context and state uncertainty.

**ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Translate Sanskrit terms by context and state uncertainty.**

11

## STAGE 11 INTEGRATED ANSWER SPINE AND QUALIFIED CONCLUSION

INTEGRATED ANSWER SPINE AND QUALIFIED CONCLUSION · ANSWER SPINE · 1. ROUTE 2023 SOCIETY/RELIGION AND 2026 WELLS, RIVERS AND · 2. WRITE SOURCE · KIN POLITY · 3. END WITH GRADUAL EARLY-TO-LATER CHANGE, CONTINUITY AND REGIONAL · EARLY VEDIC SOCIETY WAS MIXED, STRATIFYING AND KIN-ORDERED, NOT

ANSWER SPINE → 1. Route 2023 society/religion and 2026 wells, rivers and kshetra-patni. → 2. Write source → geography → economy → kin polity → society → religion. → 3. End with gradual Early-to-Later change, continuity and regional variation. → VERDICT: Early Vedic society was mixed, stratifying and kin-ordered, not monolithic.

### POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY

- ANSWER SPINE
- 1. Route 2023 society/religion and 2026 wells, rivers and kshetra-patni.

### EVIDENCE / MECHANISM

- 2. Write source → geography → economy → kin polity → society → religion.
- 3. End with gradual Early-to-Later change, continuity and regional variation.

### DEBATE / LEGACY

- VERDICT: Early Vedic society was mixed, stratifying and kin-ordered, not monolithic.
- ANSWER SPINE

**MECHANISM / VERDICT —** VERDICT: Early Vedic society was mixed, stratifying and kin-ordered, not monolithic.

**ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Early Vedic society was mixed, stratifying and kin-ordered, not monolithic.**

E

## EXTRA SUBORDINATE ENRICHMENT — ONLY AFTER THE COMPLETE CORE

OPTIONAL ADVANCED ENRICHMENT · OPTIONAL ADVANCED ORIENTATION — [OPTIONAL ADVANCED] · A1. TEXTUAL STRATIFICATION AND ORAL-FORMULAIC METHOD — [OPTIONAL ADVANCED] · A2. GIFT ECONOMY AND REDISTRIBUTION — [OPTIONAL ADVANCED] · A3. INDO-IRANIAN RELIGIOUS COMPARISON — [OPTIONAL ADVANCED] · A4. DASA/DASYU, VARNA AND BOUNDARY-MAKING — [OPTIONAL ADVANCED] · A5. HOUSEHOLD, GENDER, FUNERAL AND PHILOSOPHICAL MATERIAL — [OPTIONAL · A6. ARCHAEOLOGY, HORSE AND CHARIOT LIMITS — [OPTIONAL ADVANCED]

### OPTIONAL SOURCE DEPTH

- Optional Advanced Orientation — [OPTIONAL ADVANCED]
- A1. Textual Stratification and Oral-Formulaic Method — [OPTIONAL ADVANCED]
- A2. Gift Economy and Redistribution — [OPTIONAL ADVANCED]
- A3. Indo-Iranian Religious Comparison — [OPTIONAL ADVANCED]

### ADVANCED DEBATE

- A4. Dasa/Dasyu, Varna and Boundary-Making — [OPTIONAL ADVANCED]
- A5. Household, Gender, Funeral and Philosophical Material — [OPTIONAL ADVANCED]
- A6. Archaeology, Horse and Chariot Limits — [OPTIONAL ADVANCED]
- A7. Historical Memory and Historiography — [OPTIONAL ADVANCED]

### LEGACY / NUANCE

- Advanced Evidence Clinics: Applying the Limits — [OPTIONAL ADVANCED]
- Optional Advanced Orientation — [OPTIONAL ADVANCED] The following material enriches the core
- session but is not required for a competent Prelims or Mains answer.
- Oral stability can preserve archaic language, while composition and transmission still create layers.

**OPTIONAL STATUS —** This optional depth is unnecessary for a competent core answer; use it only for added nuance after the complete core has been written.

END OF MASTER CANVAS • poster embeds this exact master • tiled pages are overlapping crops of the same pixels